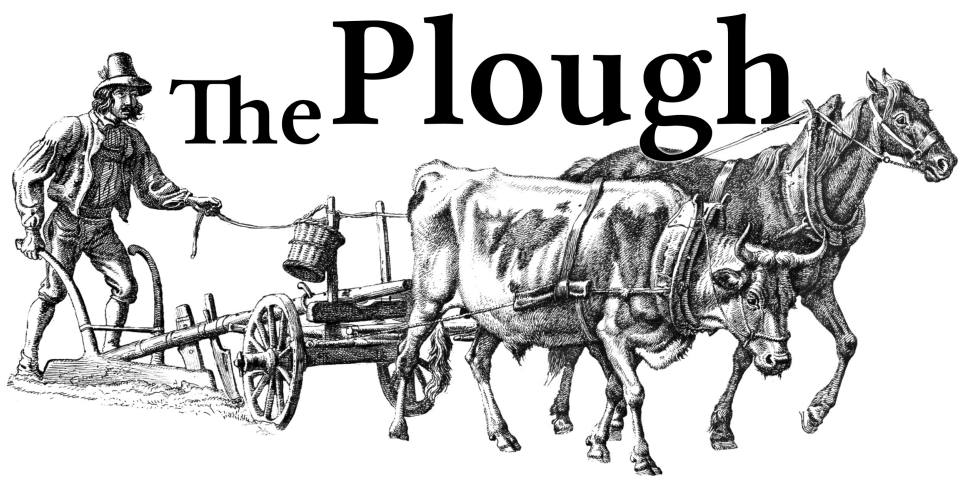




NEMO MITTENS MANUM SUAM AD ARATRUM, ET RESPICIENS RETRO, APTUS EST REGNO DEI
NO MAN PUTTING HIS HAND TO THE PLOUGH, AND LOOKING BACK, IS FIT FOR THE KINGDOM OF GOD

Featuring

Currency and The Guilds

Arthur Penty

What role did the guilds have in the regulation of commerce and the development of currency? What caused the eventual collapse in the Guilds' power to enforce the system?

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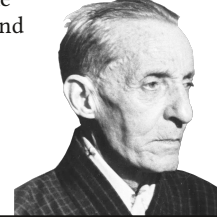


Freemasonry and Judaism

Leon de Poncins

Who is calling the shots? Is there any connection between the synagogue and the hidden sects? Leon de Poncins sheds some light on the question and presents a couple of theories.

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Issue April 2026

Freedom at Home

Fr Johannes Messner

Who was Englebert Dollfuss? The less-known Chancellor of Austria served his nation as its leader from 1932 to 1934. How close was he to the Catholic ideal?

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The Little Way of Christendom

Part II: A Strategy for Exiting The Liberal Paradigm

Theo Howard

In this second part, our author outlines a sketch for the remedy for the malaise of the modern world, and how Catholic laity are well poised to break new ground.

To build amidst civilizational collapse is the grand adventure we have been called to.

— Josué Luis Hernández

The lay genius is for building institutions.

— Marc Barnes

Intermediary institutions

Besides Our Lord's exaltation of the elect at the Eschaton, "The meek will inherit the earth" also means that those who have faith in God's providence and have children, even in times of great hardship, will inherit the temporal future. Today, one major sign of the very earliest buds of spring is the multiplying number of traditional Catholic families. Despite the worsening travails of the modern economy, more and more families are striving to faithfully follow the Church's teaching, rejecting expectations of bourgeois comfort, embracing a frugal standard of living, homeschooling their children, and trying to keep the mother at home while being entirely open to life. The family is the first institution of Christian Civilisation, so here we already have the first stones of a new

social architecture being laid amid the wider liberal decay all around us.

An increasing problem that this revival of integral Catholic family life entails is that many well-renumerated jobs in the secular world are in some way participating in constructing Antichristendom. We are building our own prison. The oligarchs have designed the economy such that the well-paid jobs in such sectors as business, finance, government bureaucracies and 'professional services' often involve building and maintaining Babylonian structures of sin. The corollary is that it is becoming nearly impossible for a publicly anti-liberal man to attain to senior positions in any organisation (including in many organisations which call themselves 'Catholic'). I personally know many capable traditionalist Catholic men who have to scrape by in precarious junior positions in fields such as business, education and law because their organisations would never risk promoting them.

The Second Vatican Council was the concordat with the liberal world where the hierarchy effectively surrendered to this Antichrist system and thus cut the legs out from any Catholic layman who might try to stand against liberalism ever since.

The successive defeats in the fight against liberalism by the Popes led to a "baptism" of defeat, that is, to a retraction of everything that had been said and to the affirmation of the compatibility between liberalism and Catholicism.

— Miguel Quesada

Liberalism attempts to dissolve all intermediary institutions so that the atomised and deracinated individual is utterly bare before the almighty state. The Catholic intermediary institutions that once formed a kind of protective framework around Catholic families in non-Catholic states (in some countries there was an entire Catholic 'pillar' of society) were dissolved on the express orders of the bishops following the Council. In Switzerland, the Catholic Conservative Party abandoned its name to become the "Democratic Popular Party" and in the canton of Ticino followed the direction of the local bishop in promoting the secularisation of the Catholic constitutional status of the canton to becoming a mixed religion polity.¹ This appalling clerical betrayal of the laity was repeated across the world with Catholic trade unions, political parties, credit unions, orders of chivalry, sodalities and schools all being forcibly stripped of their explicitly Catholic identity in the name of 'ecumenism' and *aggiornamento*. Perhaps the most famous American example was the National Legion of Decency, which had been largely successful in keeping a leash on Hollywood immorality for thirty years to the great benefit of not only American public morals but those of the entire world, but was neutered and disbanded by the American bishops during the conciliar period.

I am therefore interested in exploring ways in which Catholic men can avoid being coerced into working for avaricious institutions that despise us, in jobs that

"I am therefore interested in exploring ways in which Catholic men can avoid being coerced into working for avaricious institutions that despise us, in jobs that contribute to the construction of the panopticon Beast system."

contribute to the construction of the panopticon Beast system. Rather, let us look to build parallel institutions in which we invest our time, talent and treasure which would give us greater structures of solidarity and resilience against Regime hostility and the shockwaves from its eventual collapse. We might not be able to defeat the liberal oligarchy, but we might outlast it if we make very different commitments. What we need to do is reconstitute a Catholic social order, re-founded on Catholic lay institutions.

Following the ongoing formation of Catholic families, we next need Catholic intermediary institutions: communities, businesses, guilds, commons, craft workshops, sports clubs, almshouses, orders of knighthood and credit unions. The natural and Christian political order, with its institutions and intermediate societies, is the most propitious context for all men to direct their lives towards virtue. New

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The Little Way of Christendom Cont.

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technologies like remote working can be leveraged to gradually transition Catholic families from wage-earning households in Babylonian structures to productive domestic economies and local businesses. Learning our lesson from the last sixty years of the Church crisis, such projects would also need to be lay-governed, explicitly traditional, anti-liberal—professing the Social Kingship of Christ— and formally independent from the ecclesiastical structure, thus ensuring they would be protected from being denatured by liberalism and modernism.

Reconstituting a Catholic Social Order

No serious restitution of society or the Church can occur without a return to the first principles, yes, but before principles we must return to the ordinary reality which feeds the first principles.

— John Senior

Various commentators have remarked how it is incredibly difficult to build anything wholesome and lasting today. Financial and legal concerns are a major first hurdle. Parallel institutions cost money and need some kind of legal defence so as not to be at immediate risk of falling to the first hostile lawfare attempt. This is one area where wealthy Catholics might consider investing. Then they might consider existing Catholic businesses like *Tridentine Breweries*, which can grow and employ more men, rather than donate to Republican Party or ‘nationalist-populist’ candidates. Of course, this requires a radical change of mentality. Imagine if a wealthy Catholic man bought a few hundred acres, subsidised local housing and invited young Catholic families to come and help till this land as a commons. I venture to suggest that this might have a more fruitful long-term effect than simply continuing to donate to political or pro-life public relations campaigns. The response to aggressive globalism should be radical localism.

I concede that there would still be a need for some Catholics to engage in the wider liberal structure, particularly in order to fight important defensive battles (e.g. protecting homeschooling rights), the question is where we should devote the preponderance of our efforts. Rod Dreher’s ‘Benedict Option’ suffered from many liberal and false ecumenical presuppositions but it was not without serious insights. However, as Sebastian Morello has pointed out—a Benedict Option needs to be led by actual Benedictine monks. Andrew Willard Jones confirms this in the conclusion to his excellent *The Two Cities*:

When the medieval reform came in the eleventh century, it did not come first from above... High Medieval Christendom was built because the laity founded, purified, and populated thousands of monasteries... The cloisters changed the world... Perhaps, then, it is not to the heights of political or ecclesial power that Catholics should be looking for reform, but rather, like the laity of the eleventh century, maybe they should be building monasteries for their sons and daughters to populate. Perhaps the Church won’t break free from the world’s domination until the faithful stop thinking of the Church as merely a little corner of the world and allow themselves to be led not by the powerful, but by the religious, by the meek.²

Christendom or Martyrdom

But when they persecute you in this city, flee ye into another: for verily I say unto you, Ye shall not have gone over the cities of Israel, till the Son of man be come.

— Matthew 10:23

In this two-part essay, I have argued we need to convert our apostate nations and polities ‘from the ground up,’ as the Church did last time. Such a ‘little way of Christendom,’ or a ‘return to Nazareth,’ might seem like foolishness to the wise,

but perhaps God will look with favour on those lowly servants who put not their trust in princes, rather trusting that He will lift up the lowly from their tribulation. I do not offer a concrete programme for how different Catholic communities can move forward in their own particular circumstances. Following the principle of subsidiarity, a universal programme would be antithetical in any case, but I am interested in sharing ideas with anybody who is thinking about the Catholic future rather than lamenting the collapse of godless liberalism.

There are already promising new organisations like *New Polity*, the associated *College of St Joseph the Worker*, and the Organic Integralism of the *Pascua Florida* project that have been thinking and working along these lines. There are also long-established traditionalist institutions like Carlist circles in the Hispanic world. Each of us has a sphere of influence, no matter how limited, through which we can contribute to the future Catholic social order. The men at New Polity have made compelling arguments in favour of divesting from 401ks and workplace pensions and investing this money into cultivating local friendships and businesses instead. As Miguel Ayuso has taught us—if the political sphere is closed to us then we focus on the pre-political sphere, which is the cultural sphere. Such efforts should be as local and ‘incarnational’ as possible.

A first step that more and more families are taking is simply to start growing and rearing some of their own food. Much has been written and said about the multitude of benefits from getting one’s hands in the soil. I am also much encouraged by families turning to such traditional crafts as making clothes, learning to play traditional instruments, brewing their own beer and singing folk songs with their friends when they drink it.

Where liberals are accidentally right is that we have to be defined more by what we love and affirm, rather than what we condemn. If we focus our efforts on new parallel institutions then secular people will be increasingly attracted to, and curi-

“Such a ‘little way of Christendom,’ or a ‘return to Nazareth,’ might seem like foolishness to the wise, but perhaps God will look with favour on those lowly servants who put not their trust in princes, rather trusting that He will lift up the lowly from their tribulation.”

ous about, our ‘islands of order and peace’ amidst the worsening storm.

Ultimately, there is no choice for lay Catholics but to strive to subject the temporal order to Christ the King. With its escalating persecution and depravity, the liberal regime is extending the warfare and dissension that characterise tyranny into our homes. As Sebastian Morello has put it: we will either have Christendom or Martyrdom. There is no enduring option of bourgeois liberal comfort.

I encounter many people who say that the current temporal panorama is depressing. I say on the contrary it is cause to rejoice:

By whom also we have access through faith into this grace, wherein we stand, and glory in the hope of the glory of the sons of God. And not only so; but we glory also in tribulations, knowing that tribulation worketh patience.

— Romans 5:3

Theo Howard is the host of The Two Cities Podcast on which he treats of various topics related to the role of the Christian laity. His work can be found at <https://www.youtube.com/@thetwocitiespodcast>

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2. Jones, A. W. (2021). *The Two Cities*. Steubenville: Emmaus Road.

Currency and The Guilds

The Development and Dissolution

Arthur Penty

Our author takes us through a brief history of currency. Penty, an Englishman, wrote on Distributism and ‘Christian Socialism’ in the early 20th century. While making some ideological detours throughout his life and writing career, he nevertheless ended up settling on Distributism, siding with the likes of Messrs Chesterton and Belloc. From his book Towards a Christian Sociology, published in 1923.

It is a commonly received opinion that I gains some support from the theory of Roman law that civilisation owes its existence to the introduction of slavery. Such a view, however, is untenable. It receives no support from the actual facts, for we know that slavery existed long before civilisation came into existence. Not slavery, but the introduction of currency was the decisive factor in the situation; and it is the failure

to understand this fact that is one of the root causes of confusion in social theory. It cannot fail to strike the impartial observer as an extraordinary thing that currency, to the introduction of which civilisation owes its very existence, should have no recognised place in social theory. Yet such is the case. Its problems, which are central in civilisation, are treated as the mere technical ones of bankers and financiers, and are only approached from their point of view. But the bankers’ approach is most demonstrably a fundamentally false one; for it ignores the moral issue involved in the problem of usury, and it is because the moral factor is ignored in discussion of this problem that the whole subject is involved in such hopeless confusion. For currency, like every other social and economic problem, to be intelligible must be approached historically, in the light of a definite moral standard, and not as being a purely technical question of men who are familiar with the intricacies of finance.

Currency was first introduced in the seventh century before Christ, when the Lydian kings’ introduced stamped bars of fixed weight to replace the metal bars of unfixed weight which hitherto had served as a medium of exchange. It was a simple device the consequences of which were entirely unforeseen; but the developments that followed upon it were simply stupendous. It created an economic revolution comparable only to that which followed the invention of the steam engine in more recent times. Civilisation—that is, the development of the material accessories of life—dates from that simple invention; for by facilitating exchange it made possible differentiation of occupation, specialisation in the crafts and arts, city life and foreign trade. But along with the undoubted advantages which a fixed currency brought with it, there came an evil unknown to primitive society—the economic problem. For the introduction of currency not only undermined the common life of the Mediterranean communities, but it brought into existence the problem of capitalism. And with capitalism there came the divi-

“This doctrine—that wares should be sold at a Just Price—together with another—that the taking of interest was sinful—was insisted upon by the Church, and obedience was enforced from the pulpit, in the confessional, and in the ecclesiastical courts.”

sion of society into two distinct and hostile classes—the prosperous land-owners, merchants and money-lending class on the one hand, and the peasantry and debt slaves on the other, while incidentally it gave rise to the private ownership of land, which now for the first time could be bought and sold as a commodity.

The reason for these developments is not far to seek. So long as the exchange was carried on by barter, a natural limit was placed to the development of trade, be-

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Currency and The Guilds Cont.

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cause under such circumstances people would only exchange wares for their own personal use. Exchange would only be possible when each party to the bargain possessed some article of which the other party was in need. But with the introduction of currency circumstances changed, and for the first time in history there came into existence a class of men who bought and sold entirely for the purposes of gain. These merchants or middlemen became specialists in finance. They knew better than the peasantry the market value of things, and so they found little difficulty in taking advantage of them. Little by little they became rich and the peasantry their debtors. It is the same story wherever men are at liberty to speculate in values and exchange is unregulated—the distributor enslaves the producer. It happened in Greece, it happened in Rome, and it has happened everywhere in the modern world, for speculation in exchange brings in its train the same evils.

Though the Greeks and Romans thought a great deal about the economic problems that had followed the introduction of currency, to the end the problem eluded them. The ideal of Plato of rebuilding society anew on the principles of justice gave way to the more immediately practical aim of the Roman jurists of maintaining order. For, as I have previously pointed out, the maintenance of order rather than justice was the aim of Roman law, and as such it was an instrument for holding together a society that had been rendered unstable by

the growth of capitalism. Thus we see there is a definite connection between the development of Roman civil law and the inability of antiquity to find a solution for the problems of currency. Freedom of exchange having led to capitalism, and capitalism to social disorders, Roman law stepped into the breach, and by legalising injustices sought to preserve order. And because of this, because of the generally received opinion in Rome that injustice was necessarily involved in the administration of the commonwealth, the jurists of the Antonine period came to postulate the Law of Nature in order to provide a philosophic basis for their legal measures of practical necessity. And as reform activities have ever since the Middle Ages been influenced by the Law of Nature, we see that the vicious circle in which they move owes its existence to the general failure to give to the problem of currency its position of central importance.

Unregulated currency gradually disintegrated the civilisations of Greece and Rome, and mankind had to wait until the Middle Ages before a solution was forthcoming. When it was provided by the Guilds in the light of the teaching of Christianity, though owing to the fact that the Guilds came into existence as spontaneous and instinctive creations of the people, their significance was entirely overlooked by Medieval thinkers, who, if orthodox, confined their social and political speculations to the range of issues covered by the Civil and Canon Laws, and, if revolutionary, to the issues raised by the Law of Nature, in neither of which systems Guilds

found a place. This was one of the tragedies of the Middle Ages. For in organising the Guilds the townsmen of the Middle Ages unconsciously stumbled upon the solution of the problem of currency, but owing to the fact that the minds of thinkers and publicists of the time were engrossed with other things, the social potentialities of this great discovery were lost to the world.

What then was the solution provided by the Guilds? It was to stabilise currency by the institution of a Just and Fixed Price. The Just Price had a central place in Medieval economic theory, though, strictly speaking, the Just Price is a moral rather than an economic idea. The Medievalists understood what we are only beginning to understand—that there is no such thing as a purely economic solution of the problems of society, since economics are not to be understood as a separate and detached science considered apart from morals. On the contrary, economic issues are primarily moral issues with economic equivalents. And for this reason Medievalists insisted upon things being bought and sold at a Just Price. They taught that to buy a thing for less or to sell a thing for more than its real value was in itself unallowable and unjust, and therefore sinful, though exceptional circumstances might at times make it permissible. The institution of buying and selling was established for the common advantage of mankind, but the ends of justice and equality were defeated if one party to any transaction received a price that was more and the other less than the article was worth.

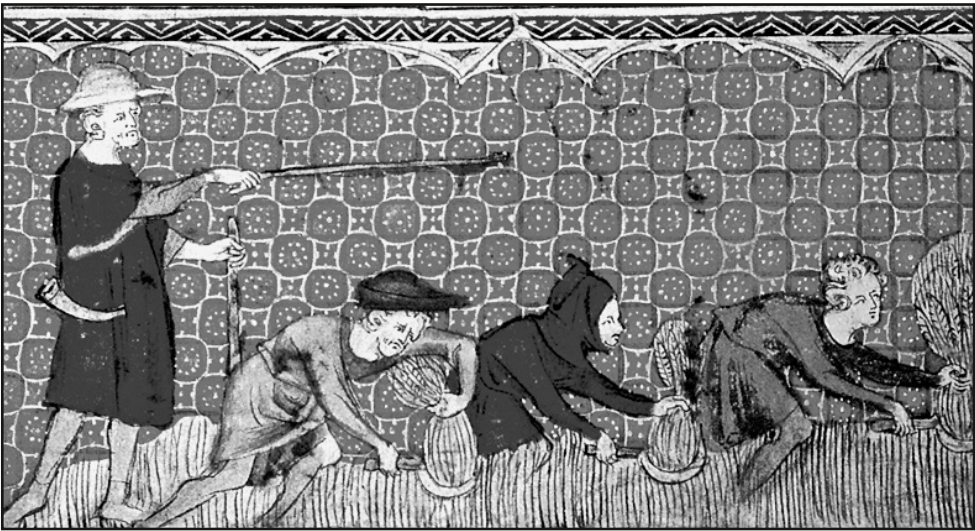
This doctrine—that wares should be sold at a Just Price—together with another—that the taking of interest was sinful—was insisted upon by the Church, and obedience was enforced from the pulpit, in the confessional, and in the ecclesiastical courts. So effectively were these doctrines impressed upon the consciences of men that their principles found their way into all the secular legislation of the period, whether of Parliament, Guild or Municipality. The differing fortunes that followed these legislative attempts to secure obedience to the principle of the Just Price is instructive, for it demonstrates the undoubted superiority of the Guild as an instrument for the performance of economic functions. Parliament could do nothing but enact laws against profiteering, and as such its actions were negative and finally ineffec-

“Hence, it came about that, when in the thirteenth century the validity of the Just Price came to be challenged by the lawyers, who maintained the right of every man to make the best bargain he could for himself, the moral sanction on which the maintenance of the Just Price ultimately rested was undermined.”

tive.

But the Guilds were positive. They sought to give effect to the principle of the Just Price by making it at the same time a Fixed Price, and around this central idea there was gradually built up the wonderful system of the corporate life of the cities. Thus, in order to perform their economic functions, the Guilds had to be privileged bodies, having a complete monopoly of their trades over the area of a particular town or city; for only through the exercise of authority over its individual members could a Guild enforce a discipline. Profiteering and other trade abuses were ruthlessly suppressed; for the first offence a member was fined; the most severe penalty was expulsion from the Guild, when a man lost the privilege of following his trade or craft in his native city. But a Just and Fixed Price cannot be maintained by moral action alone. If prices are to be fixed throughout industry, it can only be on the assumption that a standard of quality can be upheld. As a standard of quality cannot be defined in the terms of law, it is necessary, for the maintenance of a standard, to place authority in the hands of craftmasters, a consensus of whose opinion constitutes the final court of appeal. In order to ensure a supply of masters it is necessary to train apprentices, to regulate the size of the workshop, the hours of labour, the volume of production, and so forth; for only when attention is given to such matter is it possible “to ensure the permanency of practice and continuity of tradition, whereby alone the reputation of the Guild for honourable dealing and sound workmanship can be carried on

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In the early medieval period, one's labour produced one's necessities, making currency unnecessary: even "taxes" to the local lord were paid in labour or military service.

I Could if I Wanted Young Man of Character

Bishop Tihamer Toth

From his book The Young Man of Character published in 1924 in the original Hungarian.

The source of most of our faults is that our will is weak. If our will were strong we would get rid of most of our faults.

The tyrannical Roman emperor Caligula said once: “I wish all Romans taken together would have only one head so I could cut it off all at once.” The only head you have to cut off is the weakness of your will.

Many boys keep on repeating: “I could do this or that if I wanted to.” Always “if I wanted to.” Supposedly he has will power but he never tried it. At the trial it may turn out that

he only thought he had will power. These young men are like painted soldiers, always ready to shoot, threatening with fierce faces that “I am ready to shoot,” but nobody is afraid of them because they will never shoot.

There is no art in the world so refined as cultivating our own soul, because there is no material, marble or fine metal, in the hands of any artist to be shaped and formed that is as valuable as our soul is.

You have heard that man has free will; I am afraid you may have heard it all too often. Man truly has free will, but his will is not strong. Yours is not strong either, until you make it strong. Nobody is born with a strong will; it is a precious gift that we each have to gain by a serious struggle. You cannot grant yourself

strong will effortlessly; you cannot declare: “From now on I have strong will.” On the contrary, you have to work for it very hard.

The will of every boy is strong to the degree that he worked to acquire this precious treasure, to the degree that he liberated himself from the oppression of the senses. What else is spiritual freedom but self-discipline, the rule of noble sentiments over the senses and the material desires of the body? The will in your soul is like the seed sown; if you carefully nurture it, it grows up to be a great oak tree capable of resisting a storm; but if you neglect it, even the ants of small errors will make it disintegrate. Moral freedom is the reward for persevering, unflagging small efforts, for slow work, and for continuous self-improvement.

Among us come and go thousands of souls in chains of sin, exactly because they refuse to make the serious work of everyday efforts. “I could if I wanted!” Well then, want it! Try it! If you seriously want to become a man, then you should know how to want and will seriously.

Lack of will power and true willing differ as much as little pet dogs of old ladies differ from

serious watch dogs. The little pet dogs cannot bite, cannot bark, cannot do anything useful except eat and whimper and cost a lot of money. By contrast, the real watch dog does not whimper but has a powerful bark, and when necessary will bite the uninvited intruder. Similarly, the boy with will power does not whimper but barks against the temptations of laziness and sin, and even bites seriously to chase them away.

How does this work? Just like the forced march after the excursion described above. For example, do you want to get top grades in school? “I do want them!” Then give the command: “Get the lesson for tomorrow into your hands (immediately, and not next week), and left-right, left-right start the forced march.” Your desk is the anvil on which you forge your future. Do you want to be correct about your prayers? “I do want to be!” Then say your evening prayers tonight. “But I have so much studying to do.” Find five minutes right now. “And in the morning I have to hurry to school not to be late.” Well then, wake up five minutes earlier.

Currency and The Guilds Cont.

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from generation to generation,” and conditions created favourable to the production of masters. Thus we see all the regulations—as indeed the whole hierarchy of the Guilds—arising out of the primary object of maintaining the Just Price.

But it will be said: If the Medieval Guilds were such excellent institutions, why did they disappear? The immediate cause is to be found in the fact that they were not co-extensive with society. The Guilds existed in the towns, but they never came into existence in the rural areas. That was the weak place in the Medieval economic armour; for it is obvious that if a Fixed Price was finally to be maintained anywhere, it

would have to be maintained everywhere, both in town and country. That Guilds were never organised in rural areas is to be explained immediately by the fact that in the eleventh and twelfth centuries, when Guilds were organised in the towns, the agricultural population was organised under Feudalism, and money was only beginning to be used, so the problem was not pressing. But the ultimate reason is to be found in the fact that the impossibility of maintaining, in the long run, a Just Price that was not a Fixed Price was not at the time appreciated by the Church, which appears to have been blind to the need of Guild organization for its maintenance. Churchmen then thought, as so many do

today, that the world can be redeemed by moral action alone, never realising that a high standard of commercial morality can only be maintained if organisations exist to suppress a lower one. Hence, it came about that, when in the thirteenth century the validity of the Just Price came to be challenged by the lawyers, who maintained the right of every man to make the best bargain he could for himself, the moral sanction on which the maintenance of the Just Price ultimately rested was undermined. Belief in it lost its hold on the country population, and then the Guild regulations came to be regarded as unnecessary restrictions on the freedom of the individual. Thus a way was opened in rural areas for the growth of capitalism and speculation, and this made it increasingly difficult for the Guilds to maintain fixed prices in the towns, until at last, in the sixteenth century, the whole system broke down amid the economic chaos that followed the suppression of the monasteries and the wholesale importation of gold from South America, which doubled prices all over Europe. It was because the Guilds were unable to perform any longer the functions that brought them into existence that they finally fell, and not because of the Chantries Act of 1547². This Act did not attack the Guilds as economic organizations, as is commonly supposed, nor did it seek to confiscate the whole of their property, but only such part of their revenues as had already been devoted to specified religious purposes.

The explanation I have given of the decline of the Guilds is, so far as the details are concerned, the history of the decline of the English Guilds only. On the Continent, the decline pursued a different course, and as the factors in the situation were there much more complex, it is not so easy to generalise. Nevertheless, I think it is true to

“Nevertheless, I think it is true to say that the ultimate cause of their decline is to be traced to the revival of Roman law.”

say that the ultimate cause of their decline is to be traced to the revival of Roman law. The Guilds went down not because they were unfitted by their nature to grapple with the problems of a wider social intercourse, as historians have too hastily assumed, but because the moral sanctions on which they rested had been completely undermined by the revival of a system of law that gave legal sanction to usury and permitted speculation in prices. Unfortunately, the truth of the matter, which is extremely simple, has been concealed from the public by a mysterious habit of economic historians of always talking about the growth of national industry, when what they really mean is the growth of capitalist industry. If they talked about the growth of capitalist industry, everyone would understand that the failure of the Guilds was a consequence of the moral failure of Medieval society, for the issues would be clear. But instead of talking about capitalist industry, they talk about national industry, and people are led to suppose that the Guilds declined because their type of organisation became obsolete, which is not the case as we shall later see.



A master and his apprentice: the perfect image of Christian economic cooperation. Consider the modern equivalent: the young man takes a usurious loan to undertake a cobbler's degree, only to be told upon graduating that a stranger who is willing to work for slave wages is more qualified than the boy, and that the boy needs to learn the value of hard work.

1. Lydia. An important commercial center in western Asia Minor. According to Herodotus, the Lydian kings were the first to strike coins in gold and silver.

2. A chantry is an endowment for priests to sing the Holy Mass for the founder's soul. The 1547 Act was passed during the reign of King Edward VI (1547–1553), in the context of the Protestant Reformation. The act made the endowments and all associated chapels and religious institutions associated with them illegal, and thus effected their dissolution.

The Vocation and Education of a Mother

How Much On This Does Christendom Depend!

Fr W. Cramer

From *The Christian Mother* by Fr W. Cramer published in 1880.

As we have seen, the Church looks upon the vocation of a Christian mother as a thing of the greatest importance. This is the reason she introduces her with prayer and blessing into the house of God when she makes her first visit to it



after her delivery. From that time she is called, in the name and place of the Church, to assist her child, her tender boy or girl, in obtaining that happiness which Christ has prepared for it, and must therefore, first of all, lead it to the practice of piety and of the fear of God. What the ministers of the Church do with regard to grown persons the mother must, according to circumstances, do with regard to her children during their childhood; becoming thus in truth a minister of holy Church. O sublime vocation! Let us look somewhat closer at it.

With regard to the child's natural life, it is during its first years exclusively dependent upon the mother. Its organs are still too tender to take nourishment directly from nature's hand. The mother therefore, according to the wise provision of our Creator, first receives the nourishment intended for the child, and only after it has become fit for its tender life, by the operations of the organs of her own body, she offers it to her offspring. And thus the child thrives bodily and grows, as it were, in its mother's arms and at its mother's breast.

But the little one has received still another life in holy baptism—the supernatural life of sanctifying grace, by which it has become a child of God. Now,

as the Lord has deposited nourishment for the natural life in the world, so He has deposited nourishment for the supernatural life chiefly in His holy Church. The Church feeds and promotes this supernatural life by her doctrine, by her sacraments and other means of grace, and by her direction. But this she does, as long as the child's supernatural life is still tender and undeveloped, not directly, but by means of the mother. Neither is the child capable of receiving directly what is for the increase and growth of its supernatural life—that is to say, what is given to the Church for rearing it in piety and the fear of God. This must be prepared for it by its mother in a manner suited to its tender age. The mother must propose to the child sacred truths, practices and the virtues of a Christian life, in a child-like, simple, condescending manner, as if she were offering to it nourishing milk. In this sense, too, the child must in its earlier years rest, as it were, on the spiritual breast of its mother, and, in what regards the life of its soul, there it must grow and become strong.

In fact, the mother holds during her child's infancy, in the full sense of the word, the place of the Church. The command which is given by our Lord to His

“It is almost certain that, at a subsequent period of life, the edifice of a Christian life will rise very high upon such a foundation laid by such a mother; that the child will grow up a good Christian, and will arrive one day at the haven of eternal happiness.”

Church to help man to obtain his salvation, and consequently to implant in him Christian piety and the fear of God, must during his first and most tender years almost exclusively be fulfilled by the Christian mother. The Christian mother is the minister of the Church with regard to her child. Woe to her if she be ignorant or unmindful of this duty!

There is little hope that he will ever become a genuine and fervent Christian whose mother has neglected to inspire him in his infancy with a truly Christian spirit. As, generally speaking, no one comes into the possession of the blessings prepared

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The Vocation and Education of a Mother Cont.

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for him by Christ unless they are offered to him by the Church, so we also remain, for the most part, more or less deprived of them if our mothers neglect to make us acquainted with them when we are still young.

But happy the child that enjoys the care of a mother who, animated with that true spirit which should be the life of every Christian, is both able and anxious to breathe this spirit into her children from their very infancy, and to lead them to practise all kinds of Christian virtues. It is almost certain that, at a subsequent period of life, the edifice of a Christian life will rise very high upon such a foundation laid by such a mother; that the child will grow up a good Christian, and will arrive one day at the haven of eternal happiness. How great is the number of saints who owe their wonderful sanctity and the high degree of their happiness in heaven, next to God, to the salutary influence of a pious mother! Yes, how many among the saints had saints for their mothers—a most important cause of their own sanctity! What



In each of the mother's acts is contained a moral lesson for the child.

a blessing, therefore, for the child to have a truly Christian, truly pious mother!

Again, the Christian mother is the servant of the Church with regard to her children. If she fulfils her duties faithfully, blessings will go out from her to the child, and to society at large. This is the reason why the Church takes all possible care to have the mother educated in a truly Christian manner. Since God Himself has given to the mother so high and important a vocation, He wished also to make her fit to discharge its duties perfectly. This is the reason why He has endowed females with a certain natural disposition for piety and for the practice of all those virtues which are essential to the right treatment and education of tender children. According to His wise dispositions, during those years when the child's heart is most susceptible to impressions made by grown persons, it lives almost exclusively under the eyes of the mother, who is often for whole days its only companion, whilst the father is attending to his business. It is also for this reason that it is so necessary for the mother's influence to be good, and for her to be animated with the spirit of the true fear of God and of piety. Such natural disposition given by God to females renders easy the exercise of piety and of those virtues which are necessary for a mother. Woe, therefore, yes, woe to a mother if she should be wanting in them!

Great also is the endeavor of the Church to educate truly Christian mothers. Who does not know the numerous institutions, societies, communities, founded within her for the benefit of youth, to preserve in them a truly Christian spirit, and especially to shelter them from the dangers that beset their innocence? And holy Church has in view above all the training of virgins for the vocation which most of them will follow, the vocation of a mother. She is anxious to educate truly Christian mothers.

Hence her great watchfulness and care when the first step towards this highly important vocation is taken, viz., when the virgin becomes a spouse. Ah, the danger of

suffering shipwreck of that most precious good and ornament, her innocence, has perhaps now become far greater than ever. The Church knows perfectly well how great a misfortune it is when a virgin abuses the state of a bride by levity and dissoluteness. She knows the bride is suffering the loss of her most precious treasure in the loss of her innocence. How could the Church expect to see such a person become a truly good mother, in whom unfortunately together with innocence of heart and life other Christian virtues are likely to become impaired and gradually to disappear! Hence the great earnestness manifested in her exhortations and admonitions, in her warnings from the pulpit by the voice of the priest, in the confessional, and wherever occasion offers. Hence her recourse to so many means of all kinds to preserve her brides in purity and innocence of heart for their approach to the altar. If her holy endeavors are crowned with success, then they will become—this is her joyous confidence—one day good and faithful mothers. May we not, in the levity with which those behave who are already engaged to enter the state of matrimony, find the cause why so many families exhibit such sad pictures of human misery, and why the duties of parents are so much neglected therein?

The momentous hour when the virgin is to become a wife draws near. It is therefore with motherly care that the Church approaches her, leaving nothing undone, in order that this important step may be taken with the most conscientious preparation. She has made it the duty of priests to cause bride and bridegroom to appear before them for the purpose of inducing both to begin an earnest preparation, and to give them at the same time full instruction in the duties and obligations of the state of life they are about to enter. The pastor is obliged to take special care to explain to them the duties of parents, the faithful fulfilment of which he urges upon them most earnestly.

Now the time has come; the bride has to approach the altar to give her hand to the

“Now the time has come; the bride has to approach the altar to give her hand to the bridegroom, that she may become his faithful companion for life.”



Actions speak louder than words!

bridegroom, that she may become his faithful companion for life. But the Church does not allow her to come near the sacred spot at once. After having in the preceding examination induced her to make a faithful preparation, and consequently to exercise herself in acts of devotion, she exhorts her now, on the eve of her wedding, to approach also the holy sacrament of penance and holy communion, in order that she may appear at the altar free from all sin and in perfect union with the Divine Saviour. And whilst taking the important step the Church is at her side. In her presence she has to enter the alliance, in order that it may become a sacrament and receive her blessing. It is by a sacrament that the Church introduces the bride into the state of matrimony, in order that by its

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Christ's Resurrection

Meditations for Layfolk

Fr Bede Jarrett OP

An English Dominican, our author wrote on the topics of history and spirituality in the early 20th century. This article is from his book Meditations for Layfolk published in 1915.

The resurrection of our Blessed Lord from the grave has been regarded as the central mystery of the Catholic faith. Certainly from apostolic times it has been held to be the pivot round which revolved and on which depended the arguments of Christian theology. For while the death of Christ might be taken to imply that He was in no way different from other men, His triumph over death could have no other meaning than the significant challenge of His claim to unique divinity. To die in defence of one's belief is evidence, indeed, of sincerity, but it cannot demonstrate the authenticity of that conviction, since men have died for contradictory beliefs. That Christ was sincere cannot be denied; the conclusion that He was therefore divine is also itself paradoxically logical; for one who sincerely believes Himself to be God and dies to prove it, must either be hopelessly insane or really divine. But the final touch is given to the argument, and all the proof rendered irresistible when to

it is added the reappearance of the dead Christ, clothed and habited in a human body. The argument may be put thus: Our Lord claimed to be God, died to attest the sincerity of His claim, was raised up by His own divine power to life again in testimony of the truth of His doctrine. The author of life and death has therefore added His own witness to the witness of Christ. God has sealed by His power the declaration of His Son. If Christ were not God, God Himself would have been a party to the deceit.

Saint Paul is so persuaded of the efficacy of this retort that he seems to be content to base the whole argument of Christianity upon it; for he says expressly that if it be not a fact that Christ has risen from the dead, then is our faith vain. For him it is no question of spiritual experience of a risen master, but he is convinced of the bodily life of the man Christ. He proceeds, in fact, in the epistle to the Corinthians to arrange with scientific procedure those who had been witnesses of the fact of Christ's reappearance. He puts them in some sort of chronological order. The only two whom he mentions by name, Peter and James, are the very two of whom he tells us in another place that he had personal relations with in Jerusalem, nor was there evidently any expectation in the minds of those who saw Him buried that Christ would break through the portals of the tomb. Looking back they might remember the hints He had made about a three

days sojourn in the grave; but the holy women set out on the first Easter morning to anoint a body that was presumably dead, and thus preserve it from ensuing corruption. The account, too, of the disciples who were on their way to Emmaus when our Lord Himself met them, points in the same direction. They were actually going away from Jerusalem, though they had heard the report of the women that an angel had told them of the resurrection of the Master, so unprepared were they for any vision of Him. Even when the rest had seen Him, Saint Thomas could continue to doubt, confident in the unexpectedness of the event. The resurrection, then, is to be accounted a fact, not of hysteria, but of history.

For me, therefore, the historic side of the mystery must never become obscure. Undoubtedly there is a mystical meaning that lies hid within the truth. The new birth, the rising sap of spring, the feeling of hope that the very season of the year brings with it, are all contained in the notion of Easter and its festive interpretation. But beneath all that, and giving it the value which it bears for me in life, is the underlying occurrence which was witnessed to by so many: "He rose again according to the Scriptures." No hallucination will account for it, for they felt His hands and feet, and put their fingers into the print of the nails and into the open wound of the spear. By the lake-side He ate with them. In the room He appeared when not expected, was seen by more than five hundred brethren at once. This shows no sense of visionary excitement, but a fact vouched for by as good evidence as any other fact in history. On this fact our faith rests, in the sense that it tes-

tifies to the Divinity of Christ. As such the Jews demanded it, the Pharisees understood it and prepared for it, our Lord promised it; and to it the apostles confidently appealed. For me, then, it is the earnest of my own resurrection. It tells me that as He triumphed over death, so must I triumph. It bids me look forward to the new life, not back to the wasted and fallen years. It comes, indeed, as the basis of faith, but also as pointing the lesson of hopefulness, for the actions of Christ are not merely the examples that I must strive to copy, but they are still more importantly the very power by which I get grace to overcome and to attain my final reward.



Fr Bede Jarrett OP as a young priest at the turn of the century.

The Vocation and Education of a Mother Cont.



Daughter reading aloud to her mother while sewing.

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mysterious influence this state may be sanctified and become the soil, as it were, from which children may spring up in holiness, and that through its beneficial working the parents, and above all mothers, may become enabled to educate in a

truly Christian manner the children whom God will confide to them.

This is the way in which the Church acts with regard to matrimony and the vocation of mothers. It is holy in her eyes. Hence her care and endeavor to cause it also to be regarded as holy by married people, and especially by mothers, to be regarded as a state to be entered holily and to be preserved holy.

Happy the virgin and the wife who make this preparation at the hand and according to the will of holy Church. When the time comes to fulfil the duties of her vocation as a mother, then she will prove to be a truly Christian mother, and great will be the blessings which she will spread all around. This was the school in which those mothers were trained whom the Church honors as saints—Saint Elizabeth, Saint Hedwig, Saint Monica, Saint Paula, and so many others.

But to prepare thus in the school of the Church for such an important state of life, for a vocation the effects of which reach into eternity, is, especially in our days, very much neglected, yes, even despised, by a great number. Where is the spirit of

the fear of God and of piety to be found in many virgins? Alas, all their thoughts and desires tend toward dress, vain trifles, toys and pleasures! In how few is found fervor in prayer, fervor in visiting the house of God, in receiving the holy sacraments! How many are guilty of violating their most sacred duties towards parents; of spending time vainly and uselessly! And what is their innocence of heart? Alas, perhaps that jewel has long disappeared!

And what must be said of the time intervening between the betrothal and the marriage? Instead of using every means to prepare themselves as well as possible for such an important vocation, those who contemplate marriage too often pass that period in adding sin to sin. And how do they at last appear before the altar of God? Alas, the levity of the period preceding reaches even into the nuptial day. Not the least sign of that holy earnestness appears which would be becoming here. What is worst of all, do not many, in consequence of unworthy confessions and unworthy communions, receive the sacrament of matrimony sacrilegiously? It is horrible! To enter the state of matrimony with a three-

“Instead of using every means to prepare themselves as well as possible for such an important vocation, those who contemplate marriage too often pass that period in adding sin to sin.”

fold sacrilege, with a threefold mortal sin!

How can the blessing of God be expected? How, above all, can such brides be expected to become good mothers? Alas, experience teaches that the unfortunate children of such marriages have mothers who, instead of imbuing them with the spirit of the fear of God and of piety, rather become by word and example the cause of their ruin.

Freemasonry and Judaism

The Secret Powers Behind Revolution

Leon de Poncins

Our author was a Frenchman, and a Vicomte—the French equivalent of the English Count, an essayist and journalist, who wrote for many newspapers across Europe in the 20th century. His writing focused on the activities of the synagogue, and how they have positioned themselves for the dissolution of Christendom and the attempted destruction of The Catholic Church. Written in 1928, this article comes from a chapter in his book titled Freemasonry and Judaism: Secret Powers Behind Revolution.

What is the directing influence in Freemasonry? Many people answer: The Jewish power.

Here we enter upon a forbidden subject on which it is prohibited to touch. For the Jewish question is closely linked with the masonic question. At the present time Jews and freemasons are working in collaboration throughout the whole world for the triumph of the universal revolution. The high masonic posts are for the most part held by Jews in various countries¹. There are lodges which are inclusively Jewish such as the notorious masonic order of B'nai Brith whose headquarters are in Chicago. The Jewish spirit dominates masonry and imprints upon it that anti-Christian hatred, the fierceness of which would otherwise be difficult to explain. Masonry everywhere upholds and defends Jewish interests. From whence does this alliance date?

Two theories are afoot, One (the theory of Gougenot des Mousseaux, Copin-Albancelli, etc.) is: That the Jews have entirely created masonry in order to corrupt the nations of Christian civilization and to propagate behind this veil the general revolution which is to bring about the domination of Israel. It is simply a tool and a means in the hands of the Jews. In support of this we can quote the article of Dr Isaac M. Wise published in the *Israelite* of

America 3rd August 1866: Masonry is a Jewish institution, whose history, degrees, charges, passwords and explanations are Jewish from beginning to end².

The other theory (Webster, Wichtl, etc.) is: Freemasonry was a good and sound institution in principle, but revolutionary agitators, principally Jews, taking advantage of its organization as a secret society, penetrated it little by little. They have corrupted it and turned it from its moral and philanthropic aim in order to employ it for revolutionary purposes. This would explain why certain parts of freemasonry have remained intact such as English masonry.

In support of this theory we may quote what a Jew, Bernard Lazare has said in his book *l'Antisémitisme*: What were the relations between the Jews and the secret societies?

That is not easy to elucidate, for we lack reliable evidence. Obviously they did not dominate in these associations, as the writers, whom I have just mentioned, pretend; they were not necessarily the soul, the head, the grand master of masonry as Gougenot des Mousseaux affirms. It is certain however that there were Jews in the very cradle of masonry, kabbalist Jews, as some of the rites which have been preserved prove.

It is most probable that, in the years which preceded the French Revolution, they entered the councils of this sect in increasing numbers and founded secret societies themselves. There were Jews with Weishaupt, and Martinez de Pasqualis, a Jew of Portuguese origin, organized numerous groups of Illuminati in France and recruited many adepts whom he initialed into the dogma of reinstatement. The martinist lodges were mystic, while the other masonic orders were rather rationalist; a fact which permits us to say that the secret societies represented the two sides of Jewish mentality: practical rationalism and pantheism, that pantheism which, although it is a metaphysical reflection of

belief in an only God, yet sometimes leads to kabbalistic theurgy. One could easily show the agreements of these two tendencies, the alliance of Cazotte, of Ogliostro, of Martinez, of Saint Martin, of the Comte de St-Germain, of Eckartshausen, with the Encyclopedists and the Jacobins, and the manner in which, in spite of their opposition, they arrived at the same result, the weakening of Christianity. That will once again serve to prove that the Jews could be good agents of the secret societies, because the doctrines of these societies were in agreement with their own doctrines, but not that they were the originators of them³.

Both sides bring arguments in support of their respective theories which may be summed up as follows:

First Theory

Occidental people of Christian civilisation would have been incapable of this creation, for the secret society is the manifestation of an oriental and anti-Christian mentality; the perfection of masonic organisation proves that its founders had great experiences of secret societies.

The universality of freemasonry, its duration, its finity of aim which can be explained if it is Jewish and serving Jewish interests, becomes incomprehensible if it is of Christian origin. The very aim of freemasonry: the destruction of Christian civilization, reveals the Jew, for he alone can gain from it, and he alone is actuated by a sufficiently violent hatred against Christianity to be capable of this creation.

Second Theory

The principal argument of its partisans is that history does not show the Jews in the beginning of freemasonry; that they only appear in it about the first third of the nineteenth century and at that time did not yet play an original part in it⁴.

In any case the question has mainly a retrospective interest; what concerns us is the present result. How it was achieved is

“For the Jewish question is closely linked with the masonic question. At the present time Jews and freemasons are working in collaboration throughout the whole world for the triumph of the universal revolution.”

a secondary consideration. The actual result is not doubtful. Judeo-masonry is at the head of the revolutionary movement and the preponderance of Jewish influence in freemasonry is for many indisputable. It is demonstrated by reason, by Jewish assertions and by facts.

Jewish Influence Demonstrated by Reason

The chief argument may be thus summed up: Freemasonry is a secret society. It is directed by an international minority. It has sworn implacable hatred to Christianity. These three characteristic features are the very ones which charac-

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The Freemasons have been anti-Christ for circa 300 years: the Jews on the otherhand, have been anti-Christ for at least 2000 years.



Freemasonry and Judaism Cont.

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terize Jewry, which would prove that Jews are the directing element of the lodge. Only the Jews have anything to gain from the aim of masonry.

These occult societies have definitively no other real aim but that of the Judaic associations of which they are only a variant with a semi-Christian physiognomy; for the thought which directs them is the same, and we knew it before an accident had revealed the correspondence of Nubius with Piccolo-Tigre; for all their labour is limited to, all their activity applied to and expended in the propagation and hatching out of ideas and facts which must mean the annihilation of the doctrine of Christ in Christian societies. In other words, the sole aim of their efforts is the realization of the triumph of Judaic ideas, proclaimed under the name of "modern principles", by Israel itself, and of which the consequence is the Messianic age which they summon in their prayers⁵.

Arthur Preuss, an American writer, has shown in his work : *A Study in American Freemasonry*, the close affinities between masonry and the Jewish kabbala. These may be summed up in the following quotation from the celebrated mason Albert Pike:

All true dogmatical religions come from the Kabbala and lead back to it: all that is scientific and great in the religious dreams of all the illuminated such as Jacob Boehme Swedenborg, St-Martin and others similar is borrowed from, the Kabbala. All the masonic associations owe their secrets and

symbols to it⁶.

Jewish influence demonstrated by Jewish Affirmation

Let us recall the words of Dr Isaac M. Wise: Free masonry is a Jewish institution. The Jewish world wrote :

In the face of it how could they (the freemasons) honour king Solomon and reproach one of their own day for having the same blood in his veins as had the king? Regard for king Solomon, surely should teach them to regard with sympathy all who belong to the nation of which he was the glorious head. We hope that this will tend to put an end to any boycotting of Jews by freemasons. It is strange it should have occurred, seing how much, as Sir William Raynor hinted, freemasonry owes to what is essentially Jewish⁷.

Already in 1901 the German mason Findel wrote: It is less a question of a struggle for the interests of humanity than a struggle for the interests and the domination of Judaism. And, in this struggle, Judaism reveals itself as the dominant power to which freemasonry must submit. Indeed, we should not be astonished by this ; for in a hidden and carefully disguised manner Judaism is already in fact the dominating power in many a great lodge of Europe. So far as Germany is concerned, it must not be forgotten that it is master of the financial and commercial markets, master of the press, both political and masonic, and that millions of Germans are financially its debtors⁸.

Jewish Influence Demonstrated by The Facts

To show in detail the preponderance of Jewish influence in freemasonry would be to write the history of modern freemasonry and of all recent revolutions. A complete summary of this question would exceed our limits⁹.

Let us recall two recent examples: the Bolshevik revolutions in Bavaria and in Hungary. The documents which were thereafter published were seized by the Hungarian government in the archives of the masonic lodges of Buda-Pesth, and their authenticity cannot be doubted. We have already given a summary of them, so it is unnecessary to return to the subject. We shall see, further on, the part of Judeomasonry in the Bolshevik revolution in Bavaria. We can then say with all certainty: There is a close alliance between the freemasons and the Jews, and, without our having absolute material proofs of it which would be difficult to obtain in such a secret matter, there is a collection of facts which tend to prove the Jews as being the directing influence in freemasonry. So in conclusion we may quote this passage from N. H. Webster.

Behind the concrete forces of Revolution, beyond that invisible secret circle which perhaps directs them all, is there not yet another force, still more potent, that must be taken into account? In looking back over the centuries at the dark episodes that have marked the history of the human race from its earliest origins—strange and horrible cults, waves of Witchcraft, blasphemies and desecrations—how is it possible to ignore the existence of an occult power at work in the world? Individuals, sects, or races fired with the desire of world domination have provided the fighting forces of destruction. But behind them are the veritable powers of darkness in eternal conflict with the powers of light¹⁰.

The Six Point Plan

1. Religious.—By philosophy or mysticism or empiric science to undermine and discredit all Christian creed.
2. Ethical.—To corrupt morality of northern races with oriental codes—weaken

“To show in detail the preponderance of Jewish influence in freemasonry would be to write the history of modern freemasonry and of all recent revolutions.”

marriage bonds—destroy family life; abolish inheritance, even heritable names.

3. Aesthetic.—Cult of the ugly and aberrant in art, literature, music and drama—modernism—crude orientalism—degeneracy.

4. Sociological.—Abolition of aristocracy—creation of plutocracy, money standard—by vulgar display, extravagance, corruption, to create revolt in proletarian minds, hence class-war.

5. Industrial and financial.—Having destroyed ideals of craftsmanship and pride in handicraft, set up golden serpent of profit. Standardisation of cheap and shoddy—centralization—cartel and trust leading to abolition of private ownership and to state monopoly.

6. Political.—To kill patriotism and pride of race; in name of progress and evolution set up internationalism as ideal of human brotherhood. Thus undermine national unity, weaken all governments and so prepare way for their super-government which shall rule the world.

1. Let us recall that during the important period of the war, Nathan was grand master of Italian masonry and Kohn grand-master of German masonry, to quote two well known names.

2. Quoted from Gregor Schwarz Bostunitch: die Freimaurerei.

3. Bernard Lazare, l'Antisémitisme. Paris, Chailley, 1894, p. 342.

4. Those who are interested in this question can read the studies of Copin Albancelli, Deschamps, Gougenot des Mous seaux, Webster, Jouin, Wichtl, Findel, etc.

5. Gougenot des Mousseaux, Le Juif, le judaïsme et la judaïsation des peuples. Paris, 1869, p. 311.

6. Albert Pike, Morals and dogmas, pp. 744-745. Quoted by A. Preuss, Etude sur la franc-maçonnerie américaine, p. 178.

7. Jewish World, Jews and masonry, may 22 d 1921.

8. J. G. Findel, die Juden als Freimaurer, 1901, quoted by A. Rosenberg, Der Weltkampf, January 1928, n° 10, München.

9. See among others on this subject the following books : Dr Wichtl, Weltfreimaurerei, chapter viii ; A. Rosenberg, Verbrechen der Freimaurerei, chap, iv ; Mgr Jouin, Le péril judéo-maçonique, specially, t. IV.

10. N. H. Webster, Secret societies and subversive movements Conclusion. Boswell, London.



The Jewish Lodge: these lodges serve as 'mother lodges' as outlined by Fr Denis Fahey.

April Saint: Richard of Chichester

The Heroic English Bishop

Fr Alban Butler

From Lives of the Saints, Benziger Bros Edition

Richard was born, 1197, in the little town of Wyche, eight miles from Worcester, England. He and his elder brother were left orphans when young, and Richard gave up the studies which he loved, to farm his brother's impoverished estate. His brother, in gratitude for Richard's successful care, proposed to make over to him all his lands; but he refused both the estate and the offer of a brilliant marriage, to study for the priesthood at Oxford. In 1235, he was appointed, for his learning and piety, chancellor of that University, and afterwards, by St. Edmund of Canterbury, chancellor of his diocese. He stood by that Saint in his long contest with the king, and accompanied him into exile. After St. Edmund's death Richard

returned to England to toil as a simple curate, but was soon elected Bishop of Chichester in preference to the worthless nominee of Henry. The king in revenge refused to recognize the election, and seized the revenues of the see. Thus, Richard found himself fighting the same battle in which St. Edmund had died. He went to Lyons, was there consecrated by Innocent in 1245, and returning to England, in spite of his poverty and the king's hostility, exercised fully his episcopal rights, and thoroughly reformed his see. After two years his revenues were restored. Young and old loved St. Richard. He gave all he had, and worked miracles, to feed the poor and heal the sick; but when the rights or purity of the Church were concerned he was inexorable. A priest of noble blood polluted his office by sin; Richard deprived him of his benefice, and refused the king's petition in his favor. On the other hand, when a knight violently put a priest in prison, Richard

compelled the knight to walk round the priest's church with the same log of wood on his neck to which he had chained the priest; and when the burgesses of Lewes tore a criminal from the church and hanged him, Richard made them dig up the body from its unconsecrated grave, and bear it back to the sanctuary they had violated. Richard died in 1253, while preaching, at the

Pope's command, a crusade against the Saracens.

Reflection As a brother, as chancellor, and as bishop, St. Richard faithfully performed each duty of his state without a thought of his own interests. Neglect of duty is the first sign of that self-love which ends with the loss of grace.



Statue of St Richard at Chichester Cathedral

Freedom at Home

Dollfuss the Austrian Chancellor

Fr Johannes Messner

Spain had Franco, Portugal had Salazar, Italy had Mussolini, Germany had Hitler, Romania had Antonescu. These regimes, with their flaws notwithstanding, were the various reactions of Europe against the Judeo-Bolshevik revolutions. Lesser known however was Engelbert Dollfuss, who took the reigns of the Austrian Republic with his party Fatherland Front. Similar to that of Salazar, once in power, he outlawed political parties and governed Austria for the common good; he imbued his country's laws with the precepts of the Gospel as outlined by the encyclicals of the great anti-modernist popes. He met a premature end, assassinated by some of his own countrymen because of his party's stance on remaining separate from the German Reich. The Fatherland Front stood for upholding the distinct and essentially Catholic nature of Austria, and so opposed any such union with Germany on these grounds. From Fr Messner's work Dollfuss, The Austrian Patriot, published in 1935.

“On July 15, 1927, we had a sample of the aims of Marxism. The eyes of our people were opened. They saw that democracy in its actual form was nothing but a stepping stone to power for the Marxian Socialists. And therefore our people decided on positive reforms which should ensure the sound and proper development of our public life.”

— Engelbert Dollfuss, Vienna, April 2, 1933.

On the first day of the year in which Dr. Seipel died, Dr. Dollfuss recalled his saying that mistakes once made could be undone, but that there was no cure for a party spirit which had not the slightest regard for the interests of the State. Men little thought at that time that history was so soon to pass sentence of condemnation precisely upon that party which never thought of the interests of the State, but only of its own. The cause of the final break-down of Social Democracy in Austria was that, when men had now come to recognize that party warfare and class hatred are crimes against the community and were beginning to reflect upon the natural laws which govern social and political life, this party still continued to place the interests of party above the good of the State and of society.

Marxian Socialism in Austria was fully conscious that it could only gain permanent predominance in Austria if it succeeded in obliterating the two essential features of the Austrian character: patriotism and fidelity to tradition. It therefore devoted all its energies to destroying everything that could awaken in the German people of Austria the remembrance of their historic greatness. Every symbol that might serve to remind the people of their glorious past and of their duty to live worthily of that past was removed from public life, and scorn was poured upon all that savoured of patriotism or tradition. But not only were the Socialist leaders prepared to sacrifice all that was dear to the people for the sake of a cold internationalism; repeatedly and openly they betrayed their country to foreign powers in the interests of their party. The Chancellor thus accuses them:

The fact that this Government intends

to preserve the independence of Austria as our Fatherland means nothing to these people. All that they care about is that Social Democracy should prevail. They have thus proved that they have educated our good workers to be without patriotism. Otherwise they would be bound to say: “First and foremost we are Austrians, and we must welcome everything that makes for the preservation of the liberty and independence of our country.” The leaders of Social Democracy do not know their duty to their country. But I am convinced that the workers themselves understand the love of their country and the duties which it imposes. The line of division will have to be drawn between those—even Labour leaders—to whom love of country means something and between those who have become so internationalized that Fatherland means nothing to them, so long as it be Socialist. (Tulln, November 15, 1933.)

With no less vigour did the Marxist leaders wage war against the religious heritage of the people, to make room for an atheistic and materialistic Socialism. Everything they pressed into their service, from learning to sports associations, from university to kindergarten. By threats of unemployment and starvation they persuaded men to leave the Catholic Church, using methods of terrorism which were a disgrace to civilization, violating as they did the most elementary rights of human freedom. They maintained a systematic campaign to undermine public morality, especially through the cinemas and theatres which they controlled, to say nothing of educating the children of the Socialists to a religious and moral anarchy, instilling a hatred of Church and religion into their childish minds as soon as they were awakened to the light of reason. The Chancellor accuses them roundly:

Religion, they declared, was a matter of private opinion. The achievements of Social Democracy in this sphere show beyond any doubt what their aims really are. Their propaganda to induce people to apostatize, their efforts to exclude children from religious instruction, show what are the real views of Social Democracy. Under the pretext of defending the interests of the workers, great masses of the population have been brought up to be irreligious; and this is a great crime. (Tulln, November 15, 1933.)

To bring up the young to be materialists and egoists, suppressing all mention of the higher power to which they are responsible; to withhold from them the commandments to “love your neighbour” and to “honour your father and your mother”; to deprive them of any grounding in religion, is the greatest sin and the most heinous crime that can be committed against the young. (Vienna, September 11, 1933.)

To many it must have seemed surprising that a gentle, patient, peace-loving people like the Austrians, known throughout the world for their patriotism and their faith, should have been so generally dominated by a party whose terroristic methods were so much at variance with the Austrian character. But it would have been even more surprising had Austria, blessed with

an inheritance such as no other European country can boast, deriving her vital strength from an inexhaustible tradition, not returned once more to the realization of her true character and shaken off the Marxian yoke. And in fact, faced with the reawakening of the people to a sense of its high duty and its historic mission, Marxian Socialism was doomed to collapse.

Its doom was certain, even though it had been intrinsically more vital, more powerful, more united in itself. But Marxian Socialism in Austria was already marked out for a collapse before it entered upon its fateful hour. Intellectually it was sterile; during the whole of the post-war period it had not produced one single fruitful idea to relieve the people's distress. In itself it was disunited; various groups quarrelled among themselves as to what represented the true doctrine of Karl Marx. Tactically it was concentrated upon class warfare; and this could not feed a people which was crying out for bread. Add to this that the growing dissatisfaction of a great section of the Marxian working classes could no longer be restrained when they saw in certain functionaries of the party a manner of life which was entirely at variance with Socialistic principles. The rank and file of the Democratic Party could not reconcile themselves to the enormous incomes of their leaders, which vied with those of Capitalists of the purest water, while in the ranks of the proletariat poverty was daily increasing. The young Socialists especially saw in this the betrayal of their ideals and called for a complete reform of the movement. Not only was the membership of the Socialist organizations decreasing, but even the members that remained began to forsake Marxist principles, as was shown in the utter failure of the railway strike in the early days of 1933. Finally the workers simply could not understand why their leaders did nothing but oppose and hamper the strenuous efforts which the Government was making for the betterment of the economic situation and for the provision of employment and food for the people. Marxism itself quenched the fire which the ideal of Socialism had enkindled in the working classes.

Here, then, was the source of a constant menace to the State—an enemy within its borders which was ready for anything: treason, anarchy, civil war. The revolutionary group among the Socialist leaders, having gained control of the party, seeing the growing popular movement in favour of the new Austria and aware at the same time of defections in their own ranks, made

“Here, then, was the source of a constant menace to the State—an enemy within its borders which was ready for anything: treason, anarchy, civil war.”

it perfectly clear that they would shrink from nothing, not even from civil war, to maintain their ascendancy. It came on February 12, 1934. They possessed a strongly armed force, the Republican Schutzbund, and plenty of war material; they had made full provision for civil war. Their organization, so they claimed, was the best in the Marxian world, and with the proper watchwords they could set the masses in motion. For great numbers among the working classes were still mainly Marxian

Continued on Page 9



“We want the social, Christian, German state of Austria on a corporative basis, under strong, authoritative leadership! Authority does not mean arbitrariness; authority means ordered power—leadership by responsible, selfless, self-sacrificing men. Just as in the war years ago we were ready, without false heroics, to give our utmost, so we—especially we of the war generation—want selflessly, in leading the Austrian state, to do nothing but our duty.”

— Dollfuss, 1933.

NOTE FROM THE EDITOR

Welcome, dear Reader, to the seventh issue of *The Plough*.

He is Risen! May God make us worthy to share in the Glory of His resurrection!

In this season of Paschaltide, we meditate upon the Divinity of Our Lord Jesus Christ, and his sharing in His Father's Glory after the victory of the Cross. God willing, we too will share in that Glory likewise.

Our Lord suffered doing His duty. It is very popular today to talk about how the duty of a Christian is to suffer. This is of course true. But the duty of a Christian is not to suffer arbitrarily. Yes of course, in the course of our day, God will send small trials and sufferings that might seem arbitrary. Yes it is our job to suffer well these exterior sufferings that surely come from the Hand of God to try and purify us. But our suffering is not to be blind or arbitrary, but the result of our choosing God.

Take for instance, the acquiring of virtue. It is surely a suffering to mortify oneself for the attainment of virtue. But, contrawise, spiritual authors also speak of those who suffer for their

want of virtue. A paradox! To obtain virtue is to suffer, and to remain in vice is to suffer. The paradox is resolved when we consider that one must suffer *for doing what is right*.

Our Lord suffered when carrying His Cross: what a most fruitful suffering! He could've absconded, left Jerusalem, and had a quiet life somewhere and “suffered” the guilt of not doing his duty. Both courses of action require suffering, but which type of suffering is the one that Christ made glorious?

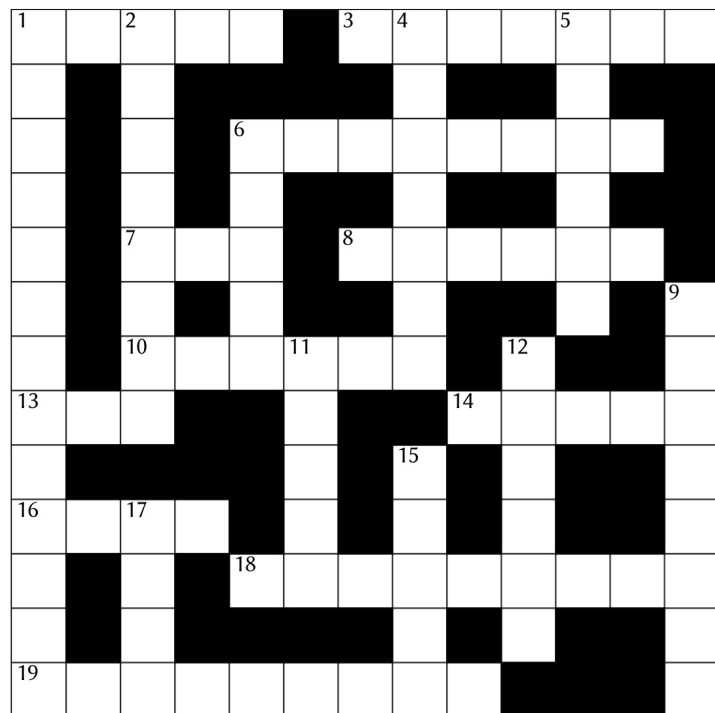
The story of our own life will be to find that “way of the cross”, which is the way in which we can suffer with Our Lord in doing the right thing. This takes courage, but surely God supplies the Grace. He will help us to say with Our Lord: “Nevertheless not as I will, but as thou wilt.” (Mt 26:39). Then we may truly enter into Our Lord's Passion, and therefore truly enter into His Glory with the Father as co-heirs with Christ forever and ever. Alleluia!

Thank you for your loyal patronage, dear Reader, and may God bless you,
Editor of *The Plough*.



PUZZLES FOR THE LETTERED FOLK

CROSSWORD



Across

- 1) The tranquility of order (5)
- 3) The rules of how smaller parts combine into larger parts, particularly in linguistics (7)
- 6) The principles of determining good and bad actions (8)
- 7) In folklore, this animal is attributed with wisdom (3)
- 8) The precious metal that was traded for Our Lord's life (6)
- 10) Greek work for cut or sever (6)
- 13) The sin of saying something untruthful in order to deceive (3)
- 14) A symbol of regal authority (5)
- 16) The flower associated with the conflict between the houses of Lancaster and of York (4)
- 18) _____ of satan: Apoc 2:9 (9)
- 19) A structure in the study of logic producing a conclusion from a major and a minor premise (9)

Down

- 1) Garb particular to a Bishop in the Roman Rite (8-5)
- 2) Precursor to the 'pub' (3-5)
- 4) The epistemology of St Thomas Aquinas, contrasting with idealism and nominalism (7)
- 5) One of the two parents of a child: charged with nurturing and the domestic cares (6)
- 6) Used in gardens for suppressing weeds and retaining moisture (5)
- 9) French-speaking city in Canada (8)
- 11) The name of the peninsula in the Mediterranean from which sprung the Roman Empire (5)
- 12) Reptilian creature mentioned in Psalm 90 (6)
- 15) An absence of order (5)
- 17) Persecutor of the Church turned Apostle (4)

CALTROP SWEEPER

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Freedom at Home Cont.

Continued from Page 8

in outlook; they were convinced that class warfare or class dictatorship was the only way of ensuring social liberty and of safeguarding the full rights of Labour. Hence the leaders of Social Democracy hoped that in the case of open warfare the call to strike would be answered by so many that in the general chaos which would result they might be able to hold out until foreign intervention became necessary. With foreign help all the reforms which the Patriotic Front had introduced could be set aside, the party system restored, and the way once more made open for the popular agitation and propaganda upon which they used to thrive in the past. This is what they meant when they claimed that they were forced to fight for the Constitution, for democracy, for the rights of the Worker against dictatorship, Fascism and social reaction. But the workers of Austria, though hitherto Marxian in sympathy, disobeyed the summons to strike by an overwhelming majority. They at any rate did not believe that the Constitution or democracy was in any great danger, for they made little difficulty in accepting the new regime. The Socialist leaders were able to bring a

few thousands of the Schutzbund on to the barricades, but in the first hours of the conflict they were compelled to acknowledge their terrible mistake. Even then they thought only of themselves; they left their people to die and fled for safety across the frontier.

By refusing to answer the summons to strike, the workers themselves had contributed in great measure to saving the country; and in his first speech after the suppression of the revolt Chancellor Dollfuss thanked them for it:

For years the radical leaders of Social Democracy had been making preparations which sooner or later had to lead to civil war. But the majority of the workers—even those who, little as they liked much of their doings, had remained loyal to their party in the elections—the great majority of them, I say, had nothing to do with these preparations, or at any rate wanted to have nothing to do with them. Our war of defence has never been directed against the workers, and never will be directed against them; it has always been directed against the radical demagogues among the Socialists and against a false doctrine which has bribed and de-

luded the working classes with false hopes. The fact alone that ninety per cent of the workers, even of those employed in private enterprises, refused to answer the summons to the General Strike, proves that the good workers, whatever may have been their political opinions before, have now no use for the party. We thank them for it! (Villach, March 4, 1934.)

Repeatedly Chancellor Dollfuss told the workers that the campaign was not directed against them, their rights or their liberties, but against the Socialist leaders and their propaganda of class hatred and class warfare. Class warfare, by fostering disunion, had brought untold misery upon the nation; moreover it was the great obstacle to the work of reconstruction which the establishment of the Corporative State was to bring about. Nevertheless Chancellor Dollfuss did not fail to recognize the justice of the workers' cause. In his appeal to the "honourable leaders of labour," he says:

At a time when the employment of labour was organized wholly according to Liberal and Capitalistic principles it was intelligible—though unjust according to our Christian conceptions—that on the other side class warfare should have been taken as a basis for the defence of the worker. But if among employers of labour there is a sincere readiness to cooperate in the new political, economic and social constitution, a readiness to take as the foundation of social and economic life the relation of man to man, viewed at a new angle and regarded as the source of mutual duties and obligations, then the antithesis of class warfare no longer exists, and Labour must seriously consider whether it is not its duty to show a like sincere readiness to cooperate in the new order of things. (Vienna, January 18, 1934.)

The party leaders of Social Democracy declared that they must make their answer to the Chancellor's appeal contingent upon the maintenance of parliamentary democracy, thus giving one more proof that their only aim was class warfare and nothing else. Therefore the Chancellor said:

“We want to institute a new order of public life, in which, through the abolition of popular agitation, lies and calumnies will be banished from politics. We intend to arouse a general consciousness that as men we have duties to one another.”

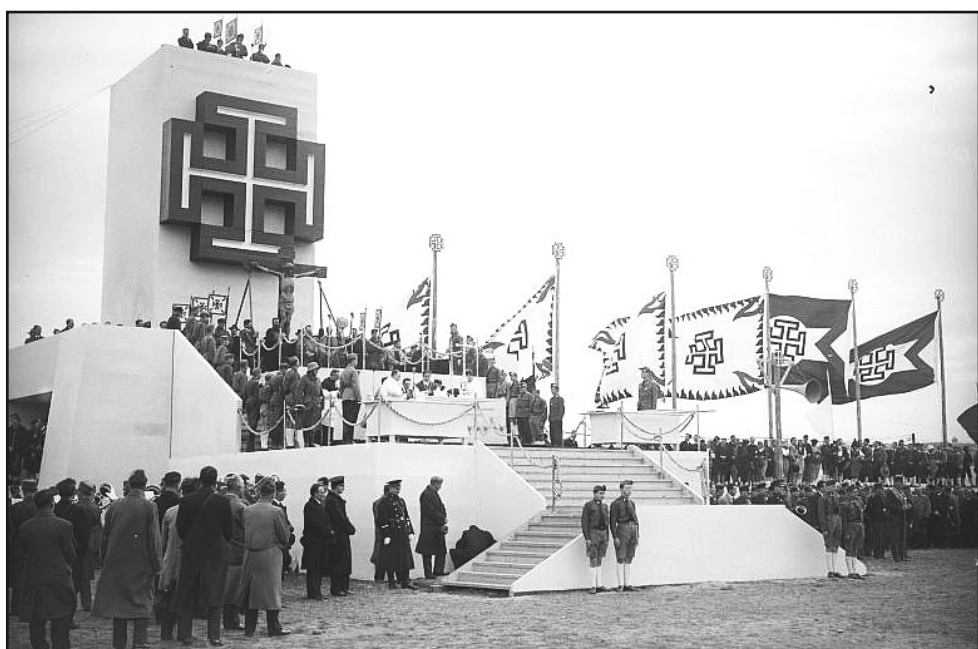
The mortal sickness of Parliament and the crisis of our so-called democracy, which has degenerated into a demagogism, has been brought about chiefly, perhaps exclusively, by Marxian Socialism. The eyes of the people have been opened at last, and it is not surprising that citizens refuse to believe now that the Marxian Socialists are honestly striving for a democracy, for self-government by the people. They are all convinced that for them democracy is only a stepping-stone to a one-sided proletarian dictatorship. (Innsbruck, April 22, 1933.)

The Chancellor emphasized the fact that Social Democracy had no responsibility towards the nation, although it had taken part in the government of the country for the last few years. Every concession for the most elementary needs of the State had to be bought from them by compromises, while they did nothing but foment antagonism towards the Government and the State. This sort of democracy must end. The Chancellor indicated the essential defect in this pseudo-democracy when he said:

There can be no permanent administration in a country when in practice nothing can be done without being approved by those who have no responsibility whatever. Such a state of things must not exist again if we are to advance and not go backwards. (Innsbruck, April 22, 1933.)

Lies and calumnies, the chief parliamentary weapons of Social Democracy, must

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A *Fatherland Front* rally. The Fatherland Front used the aesthetics of other anti-liberal states of the day. It seemed like this more centralised approach was necessary to repel the imminent Judeo-Bolshevist threat and preserve Catholic civilisation, even though the centralised approach requires a degree of compromise on the Catholic principle of subsidiarity.

Freedom at Home Cont.

Continued from Page 9
be “banished from politics”:

We want to institute a new order of public life, in which, through the abolition of popular agitation, lies and calumnies will be banished from politics. We intend to arouse a general consciousness that as men we have duties to one another; we intend to exalt man’s sense of dignity and the self-consciousness of the individual. (Vienna, April 8, 1934.)

The first condition for the revival of national life is the termination of class hatred:

We intend to prevent demagogism from causing any more harm. The fomenting of hatred must never again be made a political aim. (Vienna, April 16, 1934.)

The principle of making an arbitrary division of the nation into two camps, employers on the one hand and employees on the other, is against our conception of a sound social order and a strong national life. However, we have combated this principle only with the weapons of the mind; we have exercised no tyranny, and I have many a time pacified the rebellious. (Vienna, October 14, 1933.)

The strongest card in the game of the Socialist leaders was—and still is—to terrify the Socialist workers in Austria and abroad with the spectre of dictatorship, Austrian Fascism, or tyranny. Meanwhile the Austrian Government has explained clearly enough its conception of the new State. If democracy means personal freedom, self-government by the people, the participation of all members of the community in the shaping of national life, then the new Austria has been one of the first States to return to the path of true democracy, at the same time avoiding a party dictatorship such as has come about, for example, in Russia. That this is what Social Democracy intended to bring about in Austria is clear from the tactics which they adopted at the end of the War. When they were in power at that time they took advantage of their position to fill every branch of the public administration, including the army and a great part of the police force, with their own men. In addition they created an armed force for their own party—the Re-

publican Schutzbund—which so terrorized the whole of public life that it was only by the employment of every power at the disposal of the State that other parties could be assured the equal rights which they demanded for themselves. The burning of the Palace of Justice on July 15, 1927, was an unmistakable danger signal. They even declared before the whole world that ninety percent of them were in favour of Bolshevism. And again at the end of 1932 they declared in the National Diet that democracy was not an end in itself, but only a means to their true end, Socialism, that is, the dictatorship of the proletariat after the Bolshevik model. In view of these facts it is impossible to see in the outcry of the Socialist leaders about a dictatorship in Austria anything else but disappointment due to the fact that Chancellor Dollfuss and his Government had succeeded, at a moment of extreme danger, in quelling the Marxian outbreak, in finally defeating Marxian Socialism in Central Europe, and in repulsing a Bolshevik attack upon a central point of European civilization.

Marxian Socialism in Austria had become a standing menace to the community. February 12 made the extreme danger of the State quite obvious. Therefore the Government prescribed the necessary measures for defence, and it continues to do so until the process of reform has purged the country of the bolshevist poison which still remains. When that danger is past, then the rights and liberties of a true democracy will come into their own, as Chancellor Dollfuss intended that they should. It will be a democracy from which lies, calumnies, popular agitation and imposture will be banished, a democracy which can never again be abused to the detriment of civilization. This has nothing in common with dictatorship. On that point the Chancellor was always clear:

Austria is not the sort of country to want, or to put up with, a dictatorship or arbitrary government. But the fact that the Social Democrats, who have committed the worst possible sins against true democracy, are now arousing foreign prejudice against Austria under the pretext of defending democracy, shows what sort of men they are and the tactics they like to use. (Tulln, November 15, 1933.)

How far removed the Dollfuss State is from any form of dictatorship may be seen from the words in which he himself describes the ideal of liberty:

We want true, honourable and healthy liberty. Liberty in the sense of licence, without regard for others, independent of nature and of God, we do not want. We know that the social life of men requires certain bounds to be set to their action in order to safeguard the necessary organization and the harmony of human intercourse. Anybody who talks of liberty must first show by his own example that he is a man of inward strength and restraint.... Yes, what we want to achieve is the inner freedom of man from what only too sorely constrains us all, whether in our individual action or in our relations with others and with the community at large. In each trade, craft or profession we do not want uniformity among individuals; we want the greatest possible variety. We want to give greater freedom of movement for reorganization, and especially we want to give to the worker more right to self-expression than he has hitherto possessed. If today we talk of freedom in Austria, this is not merely a claim to the independence of our country, it means also working to free ourselves inwardly, to free our nation from the hampering restrictions of an earlier period, so that we may all cooperate effectively to build up a happier Austria. (Vienna, April 8, 1934.)

Chancellor Dollfuss never thought that Marxian Socialism could be overthrown by the use of mere external weapons. He knew that only an order of social justice could be ultimately victorious; and it was his hope that Socialist Labour would come eventually to accept the ideal of social justice and thus cooperate with him in the reconstruction of the new Austria:

Marxian Socialism will only be overthrown when the members of each craft or corporation become conscious of their mutual fellowship and solidarity, so that not only will the worker be proud of his craft and stand up for it both in and outside his workshop, but the employer too, even outside business hours, will have a personal care for the interests of his workers. I am convinced that the time will come in the near future when the workers, who now perhaps hesitate distrustfully—men who have been misled for over thirty years are not likely to take a header [dive headfirst] all at once—will see that when the employment of labour is organized in a Christian spirit they will possess a higher standing and a greater dignity as men. When the workers see that the Christian restoration does justice to them as men, their distrust will vanish forever, and then Marxian Socialism is finally and completely defeated. (Feldkirch, June 29, 1934.)

Therefore Chancellor Dollfuss spared no effort to gain the confidence of the workers. He could not believe that his untiring work for the economic life of the country, his solicitous care to provide work and food for the unemployed, his steadfast defence of the rights of Labour could fail at last to be recognized even by the most distrustful sections among them. Again and again he invited them to enter the new national community; again and again he asked them if they would not come into the new house that he had built for them. For it was his firm opinion that the workers, when once they had joined the movement, would be most valuable members of the community:

“Chancellor Dollfuss never thought that Marxian Socialism could be overthrown by the use of mere external weapons. He knew that only an order of social justice could be ultimately victorious.”

I have a great respect for these simple workers, who, though they have followed false leaders and adopted wrong methods, although their behaviour is blameworthy from the point of view of the community, have nevertheless been loyal to one another. Many of them have laid down their lives for what they considered to be just and right. These men are not “proletarians” in the bad sense. To win over these men, to gain the confidence of these men is a sublime task. Workers! We meet you, not with contempt or with distrust, but with the will to gain your confidence, to provide for you the conditions and the necessities of life, and also to give you the power to believe that Christian charity is truly a living thing which embrace all men. (Klosterneuberg, March 25, 1934.)

The behaviour of the workers on July 25 was a significant proof that Chancellor Dollfuss had not offered his hand to them in vain. He had never expected that workers, who for the whole of their lives had preserved a profound faith in the saving power of Socialism, and had fought for their convictions, would immediately follow in the paths by which he wanted to lead them. But the great majority of these workers showed, by their reverent silence in the presence of the man who had given up his life for the liberty of Austria, that their refusal to enter the national community which Chancellor Dollfuss intended to establish was not final and definitive.

A modern retyped edition of Fr Johannes Messner's work Dollfuss, An Austrian Patriot can be purchased from eocbookstore.com



The Heimwehr marching in Vienna. This group played a similar role to that of the Freikorps and eventually the Sturmabteilung in Weimar Germany: they were a paramilitary charged with protecting the meetings of The Fatherland Front, suppressing Judeo-Bolshevist malfeasance and providing personal guard support for high-ranking leaders within the party.

PUZZLE SOLUTIONS

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Catholic Integralism in Argentina

What Role Does the Nation Play in Christendom?

Alberto Ezcurra Medrano

From his pamphlet Catholic Nationalism. In it, Medrano expounds on a vision for the remedying of the ravages of individualism both economic and spiritual. He posits that the beginning of the revival of a Catholic order, might start within the nations and and then coalesce to form a new Christendom. Originally published in 1939.

There was a time when the seed of the Divine Sower, watered with the blood of the martyrs, flourished in the most magnificent culture in universal history. In that happy age, which was called the Middle Ages, there was a Christendom, in whose various functions a hierarchical subordination prevailed. Medieval Christendom was like a man in whom the soul (theology) presides over the intelligence, will, and sensibility (philosophy, politics, and art), and these over the stomach (the economy). This is how it was for many centuries. Christian humanity lived its Christianity, it had been incorporated into Christ, it was part of his Mystical Body and the Holy Spirit vivified it. That is why Religion flourished in the mysticism of Saint Bernard and Saint Bonaventure, philosophy in the intelligence of Saint Albert the Great and Saint Thomas Aquinas, and art in manifestations such as the Gothic cathedrals, the frescoes of Fra Angelico and Dante's *Divine Comedy*. Politics also flourished in the prudence of the Holy Kings: Ferdinand in Spain; Louis, in France; Henry, in Germany; Stephen, in Hungary; Edward, in England; Canute, in Denmark, and so many other kings who wisely ruled the destinies of their peoples and at whose death the chronicles could say—as they say of Saint Ferdinand—that “men tore their beards, and women tore their hair and, disregarding the decorum of their persons, went out into the streets weeping and filling the air with cries”. And finally, the economy also flourished in the medieval

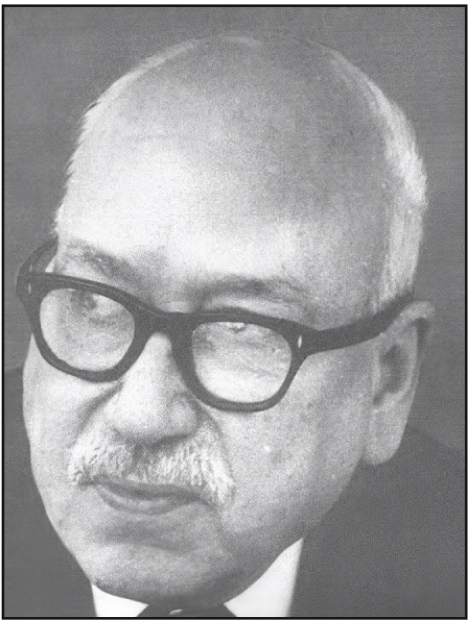
corporations, which adjusted production to consumption, ensured social peace, and offered the worker the advantages of mutual aid and cooperation, the security of finding work, and political representation. The beneficial consequences of this Christian culture were incalculable. Leo XIII summarized them thus in his encyclical *Immortale Dei*: “If Christian Europe tamed the barbarian nations and drew them from ferocity to gentleness and from superstition to the light of truth; if it victoriously repelled the invasions of the Muslims; if it obtained the primacy of civilization and is now the leader and master of peoples in every kind of laudable progress; if it was able to gladden the peoples with true and ample liberties; if, to alleviate human miseries, it sowed wise and beneficent institutions everywhere, there is no doubt that it is largely indebted to religion, in which it found inspiration and help for the greatness of so many works”. Commonly, individual apostasy begins with *worldliness* with the consent of the *will*; then the soul rebels against God; then the *intelligence* tries to justify that rebellion; finally the will is definitively fixed on evil; and man, removed from God, has no other law than his personal interest, his appetites, his stomach, to say it in a single symbolic and graphic word. A similar process has been followed by universal Apostasy. The first thing that yielded in medieval Christendom was sensibility, that is, art (Renaissance) and the will, that is, politics (rebellion of Philip the Fair against the Papacy); then the soul was corrupted, that is, religion (Reformation); then the intelligence, that is, philosophy (Cartesian Rationalism); later and definitively the will, that is, politics (Democracy); and finally the stomach prevailed, that is, the economy (Capitalism). Such was the cycle followed by Christian humanity in its separation from Christ. Sin of pride, which renews in Humanity the

sin of Adam and the sin of Lucifer, and which makes it fall for the second time before the “you shall be as gods” of whom said to God: *non serviam*. Man isolates himself from Christ and falls back on himself; he pretends to “sit in the temple of God and show himself as if he were God” (II Thess. II - 4). In doing so, he descends from the supernatural order to which God had elevated him and is reduced to his fallen nature. And as he who is not with Christ is against Him (Luke XI - 23), he becomes a servant of the Devil and prepares the way for the Antichrist, under the secret direction of Israel. The Renaissance was the first stage. “It was—says Berdiaeff—a grandiose enterprise that consisted in seeking the forces of man in his free play. Man imagined that all life could be subjected to his art. Man turned his eyes towards that nature that in the Middle Ages felt dominated by evil. Within nature he sought the sources of life and creation. And at the beginning of his relations with it he felt it revive, regenerate. Nature was freed from the anathema. People ceased to fear the demons that so frightened the people of the Middle Ages. Insensibly as for himself, man penetrated into the whirlwind of natural life, but did not unite with nature in the most intimate part of it. He submitted spiritually to its materiality, but remained separated from its soul”. The second stage—since the rebellion of the Royalty against the Papacy coincides in time, approximately, with the first—is the Protestant Reformation. The primacy of the natural, of the human, sought by the Renaissance, prepared the ground for it. For Luther there is no divine, objective, absolute Truth, but human truths, subjective, relative. Nothing is superior to individual conscience: free examination is the supreme principle that must govern man's conduct in life. The third stage is Cartesian rationalism. “My mind exists therefore God exists”. Such is the basis of Descartes' system,

“Such was the cycle followed by Christian humanity in its separation from Christ. Sin of pride, which renews in Humanity the sin of Adam and the sin of Lucifer, and which makes it fall for the second time before the “you shall be as gods” of whom said to God: *non serviam*.”

which is, in a way, the free examination of the Reformation introduced into philosophy. Descartes presupposes an *intuitive* human knowledge in terms of its mode, *innate* in terms of its origin, *independent* of things in terms of its nature; a human knowledge to which he attributes the qualities of angelic knowledge. Rational knowledge is, for him, something like a

Continued on Page 12



Portrait of Alberto Ezcurra Medrano

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR



Belgium

I am from Belgium and my wife won't come to see what should I do?

— Wilfried in Belgium

Hello for read the Plough I am really sorry to hear about that I guess she didn't grow up as a Traditional Catholic, and go to a Traditional Catholic school. That really sucks :((

Spain

Dear Editor, I was disappointed to read your article on 10 May "Young people don't read". I am tired of reading stories talking all young people as reading, but in reality, when this is just not true!

As a young person, I play tennis and without help and as a member for my fellow students and the volunteer work in my community. I also care about my family and friends, and I am passionate about tennis that some member realize that I am willing to put out the best soccer matches that I am willing to put out the best and the volunteer work in my community.

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Thank you for covering this.

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Best William Rodriguez's Member

Dr. Hovav is a great man. The Plough

Building Power outside the Jewish System

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Thank you for that very insightful analysis.

Dear Editor, I was disappointed to read your article on 10 May "Young people don't read". I am tired of reading stories talking all young people as reading, but in reality, when this is just not true!

Best The Plough

Best Argentina's City of Man

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Catholic Integralism in Argentina Cont.



Argentina: situated on the south-east of the South American continent, received more migration from Europe in than any other country in the region. Although predominantly Spanish, there also exists a large admixture of German and Italian diaspora.

Continued from Page 11

natural revelation, and our ideas, like the species infused in the angel, have their immediate rule in God, not in things. This independence of reason from the sensible origin of our ideas, from the object, leads to claiming perfect autonomy, absolute independence, for human intelligence. It is the mother idea of all modern freedoms. "Despite," says Maritain, "his powerful personal attachment to discipline and authority in political matters, Descartes is thus, in a very high sense, at the origin of the individualistic conception of human nature. From afar, but certainly, he prepares the way for the man of Jean-Jacques."

And we are already, carried by the slope, in the fourth stage: Democratic Liberalism. If—as Luther affirms—free examination, that is, individual opinion, is the supreme principle; if—as Descartes supposes—human intelligence is autonomous and independent, what will be the supreme norm in the political order? The classic doctrine of good government had as its norm the supremacy of natural law, founded on human nature and the order of things. Positive law, the order of right reason, given by legitimate power, in view of the common good, had to adapt to it. Rousseau rejects all that. For him there is no law other than the sum of individual opinions or autonomous intelligences. The supreme law is the will of the majority; and the people, the only sovereign.

The fifth and final stage is Capitalism. In it, we see the influence of the previous stages. "The conception (the soul, the form) that the man of economics will forge then," says Julio Meinvielle, "will be that of a mechanical structure, subtracted from human regulation (Descartes), with unlimited individual expansion (Rousseau), destined to multiply profit in an unlimited way (Luther)."

Thus, on the basis of Cartesian mechanism, Rousseauian individualism, and Lutheran avarice, Capitalism was born, an economic system that seeks the unlimited increase of profit through the application

of mechanical economic laws. This system presides over an era of great economic expansion, of true economic primacy, and therefore, of inverted economy, since said predominance is not of the essence of the economy since, as we have said, the stomach must be subordinated to the head and the soul. Julio Meinvielle, in his work "Catholic Conception of the Economy" (p. 241), admirably summarizes this inversion: "Economist economics," he says, "is inevitably inverted; in it we consume to produce more, we produce to sell more, we sell more to profit more, when the correct economic ordering demands that finance and commerce be at the service of production, and production at the service of consumption, and consumption at the service of man, and man at the service of God."

The Apostasy, after having disturbed Christian humanity from the soul to the stomach, has finally finished its cycle. But it has disturbed a natural order that could not be violated with impunity, and now we suffer the consequences of that five-century sin. To that apostate humanity we can apply the words of Jesus Christ about false prophets: "By their fruits you will know them." The fruit of five centuries of apostasy, the fruit of having rejected the grace of being divinized by Christ, pretending to divinize ourselves on the basis of our fallen nature, the fruit of that horrible madness, is the tremendous crisis to which the world is headed. Total crisis: religious, moral, philosophical, artistic, political, and economic. We have walked for centuries on false bases, and now what had to happen is happening: collapse, chaos, confusion.

Faced with such a disaster, the reaction also has to occur, and it does. But it can occur intelligently, rectifying the wrong path taken and trying to return, not to the Middle Ages, because history does not go backwards, but to "a new Middle Ages," as Berdiaeff calls it; or it can occur unconsciously, blindly, with no other result than aggravating the chaos and accentuating the confusion. Returning to the simile of individual apostasy, conversion must begin with grace, with the soul, that is, with religion. It is necessary to restore everything in Christ, and the first thing that needs to be restored in Christ is Christians. The conversion of Christians to Christianity is the essential condition for the restoration of a Christian order in the world. Thank God, this conversion, although on a small scale, has already begun. In Catholic Action, in the Catholic *elites* of each country, there is a return to Christian life and a better knowledge of Catholicism. And it is worthy of note that, as a fruit of this movement of religious reaction, partial reactions arise in the other fields altered by the Apostasy. Thus, neo-Thomism arises in philosophy, a certain simplicity as penitential in modern art, and a Catholic conception of politics and economics, whose notion had been lost with the rise of error. And let it not be said that Catholicism interferes in fields that do not belong to it, because while it is true that its end is essentially spiritual, it is also true that the spiritual is the first and therefore must inspire everything. Catholicism is the Truth, and therefore, insofar as there is a true philosophy, politics, and economics, there is a Catholic philosophy, politics, and economics.

We have proof of this when studying the Apostasy. It was enough for the Reformation to deny the Absolute Truth for this denial to eventually make its consequences felt in the form of a series of philosophical, political, and economic errors. Unfortunately, the modern world is not in a

position to take advantage of a Catholic reaction. The world brutalized by the Apostasy, the current bourgeois world, is incapable of feeling the religious or philosophical crisis, but it does feel the economic crisis. It is incapacitated to receive divine grace or simply to think, but not to feel a stomach ache. As it feels it, because capitalist voracity has provoked it, it reacts: but its reaction, if we may say so, is purely from the stomach. And that reaction is Socialism.

Socialism reacts, in effect, against liberal Capitalism, but it reacts blindly, instinctively, materially. It combats the economic effects of the Apostasy but stands in solidarity with the causes and the result of this contradiction is that it fails to eradicate even the effects it combats. Fighting against Capitalism, it doesn't even manage to get out of Capitalism. All it does is supplant liberal Capitalism with Marxist Capitalism, supplant the oligarchy of multi-millionaires with the oligarchy of a proletarian minority converted into the State. It suppresses a specific capitalism, the liberal one, by proclaiming collectivism against individualism; but it does not suppress generic capitalism because it leaves its deepest root subsisting: greed. Exactly the same as the liberal, Marxist Capitalism intends to hasten the economic acceleration to obtain the maximum performance and achieve economic happiness on earth, the happiness of the stomach. Both suffer from the same disease: an economic predominance that the essence of economics rejects. And humanity, sick, suffering indigestion from capitalist voracity, does not heal by changing its posture.

The remedy escapes the borders of Socialism. You cannot cure the evil from the bottom up, when the causes are above. You cannot cure with material remedies, when the evil is spiritual. One would have to start by destroying the root of that greed common to the two capitalisms and this is not achieved without a Christian concept of life, which is not a definitive goal, but a "valley of tears," a transit towards another better life. One would have to restore the primacy of religion over politics and of politics over economics. One would have to make, according to the phrase already cited, that "finance and commerce were at the service of production and this at the service of consumption, and consumption at the service of man and man at the service of God." But this, to reestablish the primacy of the soul and the head over the stomach, is not easy for this sybaritic humanity. The remedy is harsh: painful penance for past disorders. And current humanity is a spoiled child: it does not like the remedy and prefers to change its posture...

The economic reaction was the first to occur, but it is not the only one. It was evident that the change of posture did not cure sick humanity and the experiment conducted on Russia left much to be desired. On the other hand, the political crisis was also being felt intensely. The disrepute of democracy was increasing and despite the excuses of its fervent supporters who attributed the flaws to man in order to save the system, the idea that it was necessary to find other systems more adaptable to man was taking hold. Then emerged a strong reaction, already in a higher order than the economic one, but without neglecting this one; a reaction at the same time against Liberalism and against Socialism. It was the political reaction embodied in *Nationalism*.

If we were to characterize the nationalist movement in a few words, we would say that it advocates a strong government and

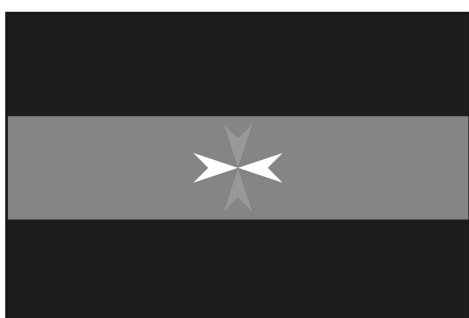
"Socialism suppresses a specific capitalism, the liberal one, by proclaiming collectivism against individualism; but it does not suppress generic capitalism because it leaves its deepest root subsisting: greed."

a corporatist regime as a reaction against liberal individualism; and the cult of God and the Fatherland and an exaltation of moral values as a reaction against Marxist atheism, internationalism, and materialism.

In our simile of the two apostasies, individual and universal, we had called the economy the *stomach* and had qualified socialism as a *stomach* reaction. We had identified politics with the *will*. This is going to point out the enormous importance of the nationalist reaction. In misguided humanity, Nationalism is, no longer the blind and instinctive reaction of the sore stomach, but the reaction of something as important as the *will*. And this, although it should fill us with hope regarding the future of the world, also fills us with a fervent desire for that will to find the right path. It is already a lot that it has reacted; but that alone is not enough. If the stomach could only react blindly in one sense, the will, which is an intellectual faculty, can do so—and in fact is doing so—in several. Whether it ultimately does so in the sense of Truth, depends in large part on the straightening of the world in these tragic times.



Of Medrano's seven children, three of his sons became priests. Depicted above is Alberto Ezcurra Uribe, who, following in his father's footsteps lead the Tacuara, before entering the seminary in Argentina.



The flag of the *Tacuara*, the national movement inspired by the work of our author Alberto Ezcurra Medrano.